CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 4

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- Certain bicycle parts are sold separately.
- The store doesn't sell what he needs.
- Some parts have fallen off his bike.
- His new bicycle is broken already.

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- one
- two
- three
- four

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- a replacement battery
- a narrow reflector strip
- a softer type of seat
- a helmet with a light

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- special orders
- opened items
- used merchandise
- bicycle accessories

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- to order an item
- to pick up a special order
- to get advice about his bike
- to exchange an item

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- The woman says it's necessary.
- He likes the sound of it.
- It matches his bike.
- It is a precaution.

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- He is quite excited.
- He is very unhappy.
- He has mixed feelings.
- He has hidden feelings.

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ to ask about cleaning a chimney
- ◯ to ask about a woodstove
- ◯ to discuss one of his trees
- ◯ to learn about buying wood

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He wants to give the woman the wood.
- ◯ He's worried the tree might fall down.
- ◯ He'll use the tree for a Christmas tree.
- ◯ His wife expects him to burn the tree.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ His woodstove is dirty.
- ◯ He burns softwood.
- ◯ His wife likes a clean house.
- ◯ He needs house insurance.

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ how to store firewood
- ◯ how to avoid a chimney fire
- ◯ how to save on fire insurance
- ◯ how to cut down a tree

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ take some of her wood
- ◯ remove the tree now
- ◯ build his own woodpile
- ◯ burn the softwood quickly

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ His children use their credit cards too much.
- ◯ His children refuse to do their chores.
- ◯ His children want to get casual jobs.
- ◯ His children need to handle money better.

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ His children put too many purchases on his credit card.
- ◯ He is delighted that his children do their chores.
- ◯ He is surprised by the products his children choose.
- ◯ His children waste money on things they never use.

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ A child could lose the credit cards.
- ◯ A child cannot understand the concepts involved.
- ◯ A child is too young for the responsibility.
- ◯ A child cannot control their spending habits.

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ one that corresponds to age
- ◯ one that supplements a part-time job
- ◯ part guaranteed income and part reward
- ◯ part weekly payment and part annual bonus

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ They proved too young to do chores properly.
- ◯ They acquired time-consuming part-time jobs.
- ◯ They argued with him about doing the chores.
- ◯ They needed to spend more time on schoolwork.

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ to illustrate wise and unwise uses of an allowance
- ◯ to explain how an allowance should be allocated
- ◯ to suggest that working is not very enjoyable
- ◯ to provide ideas for increasing an allowance

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. The story is about _____
- ◯ a puzzling sport.
- ◯ an innovative rescue.
- ◯ a common occurrence.
- ◯ an unlikely accident.

2. Chu was concerned about _____
- ◯ being injured or infected.
- ◯ hitting the ice.
- ◯ tipping the kayak.
- ◯ getting too cold or too wet.

3. The food was provided to _____
- ◯ reward.
- ◯ confuse.
- ◯ distract.
- ◯ attract.

4. The fox got to shore on a _____
- ◯ kayak.
- ◯ piece of wood.
- ◯ surfboard.
- ◯ chunk of ice.

5. Chu mentions geese _____
- ◯ as part of a possible explanation.
- ◯ to tell a different story.
- ◯ to raise an interesting question.
- ◯ as response to a question.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What are the three owners discussing?
- ◯ creating space to sell more products
- ◯ extending store hours to include nights
- ◯ preventing a large store from opening
- ◯ losing customers to a future competitor

2. What type of products does their store mainly sell?
- ◯ international foods
- ◯ typical grocery items
- ◯ specialty food products
- ◯ freshly baked goods

3. Why does the man in red speak about sitting in his chair?
- ◯ to remind others that it is broken and must be fixed
- ◯ to show that he is tired of discussing the situation
- ◯ to suggest a way to improve customer satisfaction
- ◯ to indicate he wants to act before there is a problem

4. Where do many of their customers come from originally?
- ◯ across town
- ◯ Ethiopia
- ◯ other countries
- ◯ Canada

5. What is the woman's attitude throughout the discussion?
- ◯ excited
- ◯ cautious
- ◯ positive
- ◯ negative

6. Which statement would the woman likely agree with?
- ◯ Smaller can sometimes be better.
- ◯ It's impossible to please everyone.
- ◯ Variety is usually more convenient.
- ◯ Copying large stores makes sense.

PART 5

7. How does the discussion end?

- ◯ with a decision
- ◯ in confusion
- ◯ with a new question
- ◯ in a hurry

8. What will the owners likely do next?

- ◯ advertise to attract new customers
- ◯ add clothing items to their store
- ◯ get opinions from their regular customers
- ◯ move their store to a different location

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. What is the presentation mainly about?

- ◯ whether there should be a maximum wage
- ◯ how high a maximum wage should be
- ◯ whether the minimum wage should be raised
- ◯ why the minimum wage should be eliminated

2. According to the speaker, what happens whenever the minimum wage is increased?

- ◯ People complain that it is still too low.
- ◯ People start to work harder at their jobs.
- ◯ People begin talking about a maximum wage.
- ◯ People question the government's motives

3. What does philosopher Judith Meyer think about wage ceilings?

- ◯ They should take into account the type of job.
- ◯ They are a fair concept to implement in Canada.
- ◯ They should be applied only to high-level CEOs.
- ◯ They are interesting to consider only in theory.

4. What does sociologist Michael Mishin most likely believe?

- ◯ There is a consensus about what is a fair wage.
- ◯ A person's effort should determine their wage.
- ◯ Few people work as hard as professional athletes do.
- ◯ It is difficult to agree on what benefits society.

5. According to the speaker, what have several studies shown?

- ◯ Wealth does not flow from the rich to the poor.
- ◯ High-income earners seldom cheat on their taxes.
- ◯ High-income earners invest more than they spend.
- ◯ Reduced tax revenue will have little consequence.

6. What does the speaker suggest about herself?

- ◯ She opposes the idea of a maximum wage.
- ◯ She has had money but not happiness.
- ◯ She thinks most people are not motivated by money.
- ◯ She is mainly driven by potential financial gains.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	
Question 2	Certain bicycle parts are sold separately.
Question 3	two
Question 4	a softer type of seat
Question 5	used merchandise
Question 6	to order an item
Question 7	It is a precaution.
Question 8	He has mixed feelings.

PART 2	
Question 1	to discuss one of his trees
Question 2	He's worried the tree might fall down.
Question 3	He needs house insurance.
Question 4	how to avoid a chimney fire
Question 5	take some of her wood

PART 3	
Question 1	His children need to handle money better.
Question 2	His children put too many purchases on his credit card.
Question 3	A child cannot understand the concepts involved.
Question 4	part guaranteed income and part reward
Question 5	They argued with him about doing the chores.
Question 6	to explain how an allowance should be allocated

PART 4	
Question 1	an innovative rescue.
Question 2	being injured or infected.
Question 3	attract.
Question 4	surfboard.
Question 5	as part of a possible explanation.

PART 5	
Question 1	losing customers to a future competitor
Question 2	typical grocery items
Question 3	to indicate he wants to act before there is a problem
Question 4	other countries
Question 5	positive
Question 6	Smaller can sometimes be better.
Question 7	with a decision
Question 8	get opinions from their regular customers

PART 6	
Question 1	whether there should be a maximum wage
Question 2	People begin talking about a maximum wage.
Question 3	They are a fair concept to implement in Canada.
Question 4	It is difficult to agree on what benefits society.
Question 5	Wealth does not flow from the rich to the poor.
Question 6	She has had money but not happiness.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman. The man is a customer at a store, and the woman works at the store.

Section 1:

MAN: Hello! I bought one of your bicycles last week. I guess I didn't look at it carefully enough, because yesterday when I had to ride home in the rain, I realized it doesn't have any of those . . . uh . . . things that cover the wheels . . . you know . . . fenders. My clothes got all wet and dirty.

WOMAN: I'm sorry to hear that! None of the bikes we sell include fenders. They have to be purchased on their own.

MAN: Really? I just assumed they'd be part of the bike, like the handlebars.

WOMAN: I'm afraid not. [pause] We do have packages that include front and back fenders, and all the hardware you need to install them yourself.

MAN: All right, I guess I need to buy that package.

Now answer questions 1-2.

1. What does the man want?
2. What surprises the man?

Section 2:

WOMAN: Hello again! Oh . . . is there a problem with the fenders you bought?

MAN: No, they're fine, but I had to ride home last night in the dark, and then I realized that the bike doesn't have a light.

WOMAN: Yes, they're extra as well. We have battery-operated lights that go on the front of the bike—they're white—and we have reflector lights that go on the back—they're red.

MAN: This is ridiculous! Soon you'll be selling bikes and saying the wheels and seats are extra! Speaking of which, the seat on the bike is narrow and hard. It's uncomfortable.

WOMAN: I can special order a seat for you that's wider and has more cushioning.

MAN: How much is it?

WOMAN: Well, it is expensive—$70—but this padded seat cover is only $17.

MAN: Hm . . . I have a long ride . . . Can I return the seat cover if it doesn't do the job?

WOMAN: Well, we're supposed to allow returns only on equipment that's still brand new, but if you try it only for a few minutes and keep the original packaging, I suppose that it will be okay.

Now answer questions 3-5.

3. How many kinds of lights does the woman describe?
4. What does the man want?
5. What does the store refuse to take back?

Transcripts

Section 3:

MAN: It's me again. I'd like to get that seat you mentioned. If I order it today, when will it be here?

WOMAN: Friday. Would you like it in black or grey?

MAN: Black, please. Now, while I'm here, is there any other important thing that didn't come with the bike?

WOMAN: The only other thing I can think of is that some people like to have a small horn or bell to warn pedestrians of their approach.

MAN: Oh, that's a good idea. I don't want to run into anyone by accident! I'll buy whichever is loudest.

WOMAN: That would be the horn. Will there be anything else?

MAN: No, I'm not thrilled about how much all this is costing, but I'm happy to finally have everything I need.

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. Why does the man return to the shop this time?
7. What drives the man's decision to buy a horn?
8. What best describes the man in the end?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a conversation between two neighbours.

MAN: Hi Janice. It looks like summer's over, doesn't it?

WOMAN: Yes, it does. Pretty soon it'll be time for nice warm fires in the fireplace, right?

MAN: Yeah. Hey, you know that old tree in my backyard? The one that keeps its needles all year long? I forget what it's called, but it looks like a Christmas tree.

WOMAN: Your evergreen is a fir tree. I love looking at it through my kitchen window when I'm doing the dishes. The birds enjoy the tree, too, especially the sparrows.

MAN: Well, I know nothing about trees or birds, but this tree looks kind of old. Maybe it should be cut down before a strong wind or a storm takes it down. What do you think?

WOMAN: Well, it's easy enough to cut down because it's a softwood tree. But do you really want to cut down your beautiful fir tree?

MAN: Well, you know we just had a woodstove installed, and I thought it would be good for firewood! However, John across the street said this kind of wood isn't good for woodstoves. What do you think?

WOMAN: I agree with John because softwood has a lot of resin, or sticky sap. When it burns, it messes up the inside of your chimney. This causes a problem that has to be cleaned out by a chimney cleaning specialist or you'll have a chimney fire.

MAN: Wow, I'm glad I asked you! You sure know a lot about firewood! Doesn't the chimney have to be cleaned out every year, though, for safety and insurance reasons?

WOMAN: Definitely, but your chimney will stay cleaner if you burn only hardwood. All that firewood we have stacked beside our garage is hardwood. Take some of that, if you like, because we have more than enough.

MAN: That's very generous of you, but Mary wants us to have our own woodpile. I thought cutting down that tree would be a good start.

WOMAN: Well, although it's your tree, I really love it! Perhaps you could take a big stack of our firewood in exchange for leaving the tree as it is? Then we'll all be happy!

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. What is the man's purpose in talking to the woman?
2. Why does the man want to cut down his tree?
3. Why does the man need his chimney cleaned?
4. What information has the man learned?
5. What solution does the woman suggest?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman. The woman is a child behaviour expert and the man is a father.

MAN: Thank you for meeting with me. I wanted to ask for your advice about how to teach my kids some financial responsibility. They keep coming to me for money because they keep exceeding their maximum internet allotment. Every time they ask me, I give them my credit card to make the purchase. Oh my!

WOMAN: I take it your children are teenagers? I would advise not giving a credit card to a child. The concept of buying on credit would be beyond their comprehension.

MAN: I have two children. One is fifteen; the other is ten. Both have problems understanding money, but yes, only the teenager uses the credit card.

WOMAN: I see. What have you done to this point to teach them financial responsibility?

MAN: Well, I remind them that money doesn't grow on trees, that I can't keep giving them money.

WOMAN: And then you do just that? Keep giving them money?

MAN: Well, yes. They don't have jobs . . .

WOMAN: They should! They should have chores, jobs at home that they need to do in order to get their allowance. You give them an allowance, right?

MAN: Well, actually . . . I thought that would be the wrong thing to do — to just give them money every week.

WOMAN: Only part of it should be given, no matter what. The rest of it should be earned. It should be payment for doing the assigned chores. If they have never had to work for the money they get, you can see why they don't value it, right?

MAN: Yes, you're right . . . I did try giving them chores to do at one time, but they just . . . didn't do them. We got into awful fights.

WOMAN: If they don't do their chores, then they shouldn't get paid. You should withhold that portion of their allowance. If they had to work for their money, and if you insisted they put some of it aside for Savings, some for Charity, and the rest for Fun. . .

MAN: Then they would develop some self-discipline. They would learn that money doesn't grow on trees!

WOMAN: Exactly! And if they know there's only so much they can earn, they would choose more carefully how to spend it.

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. What problem does the man have?
2. What does the man likely mean when he says, "Oh my?"
3. Why does the woman discourage giving credit cards to a child?
4. What kind of allowance does the woman suggest?
5. Why does the man stop assigning chores to his kids?
6. Why does the woman mention savings and fun?

PART 4

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about a Pine Lake resident.

When Pine Lake resident Kim Chu noticed what she thought was a dog stranded on a chunk of floating ice, she paddled out in her kayak to provide help. As she approached, she realized it was a fox! "I wasn't keen on having a wild animal in the kayak with me," Chu said. "It didn't look sick, but you never know." She thought maybe it would just step onto the prow for a ride back to shore, but the animal backed away at Chu's approach, then paced back and forth, clearly distressed.

She returned to shore, tied a Styrofoam surf board to her kayak, put some food on it, then paddled back out. "I pulled up beside the ice, then just waited," Chu said. Eventually the fox stepped onto the board and started nibbling. Chu carefully paddled away, back toward shore. "The little fox just surfed its way back, behind me!" she said. Chu speculates that the fox chased after some geese only to discover that the ice had shifted away from shore. "And I don't blame it for not wanting to swim back," she said.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion between three people: two men and one woman. They are the owners of a family-run convenience store. The conversation is taking place in the break room.

Ron: So . . . it's official! This April, a Supershop is opening up . . . just a block from us.

Jeremy: Well that's great, there goes half our customers! Who's gonna shop here when "grocery heaven" is up the street? We won't stand a chance!

Tina: Actually, I think we'll be OK! I mean, sure, a Supershop offers a lot more variety than us, and customers probably like to be able to buy clothes for their kids in the same place as their milk, but, we offer a different form of convenience.

Ron: Like what? We offer far fewer products.

Tina: Well, yeah. We might not have the space to offer as much selection, but what if what we do offer is exactly what the customer wants, it saves them time! It's way quicker to find what you want in our store than in one with endless aisles and every kind of dish detergent under the sun.

Jeremy: True. But we still need a plan. I don't want to just sit in this chair and watch our customers pass by on their way to the Supershop.

Ron: Well, we're already open all day every day, so extending our store hours isn't possible. But I agree with Tina . . . we want to make sure we stock exactly what the customer wants.

Tina: Yeah, so . . . we'd probably have to make a few changes, since what we sell now is the same as what you'd find in a Supershop. But I'm thinking . . . we're located in a culturally diverse community . . . we have people from all over the map that shop here. What if we were to specialize in international foods?

Jeremy: It's true, this is a really diverse area. Actually, just the other day, there was a man who moved to Canada recently from Ethiopia. He was telling me - he drives across town every week to pick up fresh injera – it's an Ethiopian bread he misses. What if we were to go to his supplier and stock injera bread in our store? He could buy it here from us! Way more convenient!

Ron: This could actually work. (laughs) I don't imagine you'll be able to find injera bread at the Supershop anytime soon. Maybe we could even start a survey . . . ask our customers what products they'd like to purchase, but can't find at a regular grocery store.

Tina: Great idea! See, we've got nothing to worry about . . . (laughs) It's the Supershop that should watch out for us!

Jeremy: Yeah . . . !

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about a controversial wage issue.

Canadian labour law stipulates the lowest hourly rate employers can pay their employees. Any increase in this minimum wage invariably draws attention, which invariably sparks suggestions that Canada implement a maximum wage. Philosopher Judith Meyer argues that such a proposal is consistent with principles of justice. There is a limit to how hard people can work, so there should be a limit to how much they are paid. If it is impossible for someone to work twenty times harder than everyone else, then that person shouldn't be paid twenty times more than everyone else. Meyer points out that many high-income earners in Canada are paid two hundred times the average Canadian. She also points out that limiting the pay of CEOs, or Chief Executive Officers, to one hundred times the minimum wage would still enable them to make about $1.5 million per year.

Sociologist Michael Mishin counters that effort shouldn't be the measuring stick. Using athletes' exorbitant high incomes as an example, he suggests that it doesn't matter if someone works harder than everyone else to run a hundred metres in under ten seconds. If that doesn't contribute to society in any way, why should we pay the person anything at all, let alone more than everyone else? Measuring contribution to society, however, requires consensus about values, and Mishin admits such a consensus is unlikely.

Economist Ethel Ellis presents yet another view. If we reduce the income of our high-income earners, we reduce the amount of money they can put back into circulation by spending, she says. However, this assumption that money trickles down from high-income earners to the rest of us is challenged by several studies. Furthermore, Ellis says, if we reduce the income of our high-income earners, we reduce the amount of taxes they pay. That is a consequence we should think very carefully about. Cynics respond, however, that high-income earners are already paying reduced taxes because they know very well how to take advantage of loopholes in the tax laws.

Yet another argument against a wage ceiling is that it would reduce the drive to do more and to do better. A worst case scenario is that the high-income earners would leave and move to a country without a wage ceiling. Recalling Meyer's point, though, surely $1.5 million per year provides motivation enough. And if not, perhaps people should re-evaluate their priorities. As they say, money can't buy happiness—and I can certainly attest to that!